PAKISTAN PEOPLES PARTY (PPP)



ASIF ALI ZARDARI

The widower of Benazir Bhutto, Zardari became president of Pakistan after the general elections in 2008. Mentor to the party.



BILAWAL BHUTTO ZARDARI

Chairperson of the PPP and a prime mover against the Imran Khan government but seen as an inexperienced politician.

PAKISTAN MUSLIM LEAGUE-QAID-E-ASAM (PML-Q)



SHUJAAT HUSSAIN

Once PML-N president, Hussain became leader of the PML-N splinter group PML-Q, supported Gen. Musharraf's coup. Was briefly Pakistan PM.



PERVAIZ ILAHI

Cousin of Shujaat, Pervaiz Ilahi was CM of Punjab from 2002-'07. Elahi is now being backed by PTI to be elected Punjab CM after incumbent Usman Buzdar resigned recently.

MUTTAHEDA QAUMI MOVEMENT-LONDON (MQM-L)



ALTAF HUSSAIN

Founder of MQM, he held immense sway in Karachi and urban Sindh. With his party mired in political violence, Hussain shifted to London in 1992. His party boycotted the 2018 elections, alleging military interference.

MUTTAHEDA QAUMI MOVEMENT-PAKISTAN (MQM-P)



KHALID MAQBOOL SIDDIQUI

Leader of the splinter group of MQM that parted ways with Altaf Hussain in 2016. Was an ally of Imran's PTI government before withdrawing support on March 30 this year and joining with the opposition.

BALOCHISTAN AWAMI PARTY (BAP)



JAM KAMAL KHAN

Founded by disaffected PML-N and PML-Q politicians in Balochistan in 2018, the BAP backed the PTI-led coalition. It no longer backs the PTI. Jam Kamal Khan served as CM of Balochistan from 2018-21.

JAMIAT ULEMA-E-ISLAM (JUI)



MAULANA FAZLUR REHMAN

Leader of the JUI, Maulana Fazlur Rehman has long been a vocal critic of Imran and the PTI and currently chairs the united opposition's Pakistan Democratic Front.

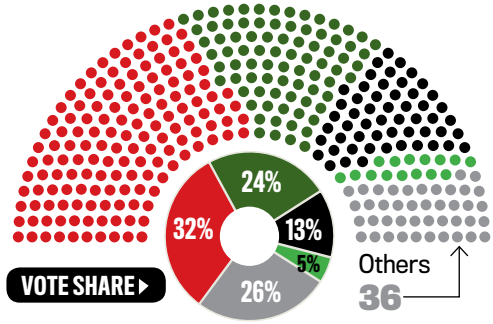
The 'Electables': These are politicians with their own votebanks. Most 'electables' are affiliated with parties, some contest as independents.

RESULTS OF THE PAKISTANI GENERAL ELECTION, 2018

Total seats in National Assembly **342**

SEATS WON BY PARTIES

Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf	Pakistan Muslim League (N)	Pakistan Peoples Party	Muttahida Majlis-e-Amal
155	82	54	15



election, the debris of economic mismanagement in popular perception will shift from Imran on to them.

The opposition also does not yet have a politician who can match Imran's personal charisma. In the PML-N, Nawaz Sharif and especially Maryam Nawaz do have personal charisma, but they are also currently bogged down with pending cases and convictions that have disqualified them from standing for election. They will be looking first to have those overturned before they can participate actively in electoral politics. The likely PM contender, Shehbaz Sharif, is "more like a CEO", in the words of one of his own party workers. He also has corruption charges pending against him. In the PPP, Bilawal Bhutto-Zardari, despite his popularity among supporters, is still too green and his party has steadily lost support in Punjab and KP, which means the PPP can at best hope to retain its stronghold in Sindh. Meanwhile, Imran will also be hoping that there are no long-term legal repercussions from the Supreme Court findings, even if they go against him. But at least he would have learnt one thing from recent events: if you live by the hybrid sword, you die by the hybrid sword too. ■